- Allergy and Food sensitivity
- Carcinoma of small intestine and colon
- Cirrhosis of liver

Goals for dietary treatment

- To watch for the symptoms of dehydration and prevent dehydration
- To replace the fluid and electrolytes
- To remove the cause especially the infection
- To correct the nutritional deficiencies

Golden rule for diet treatment

FEEDING THE CHILD IS BETTER THAN STARVING THE CHILD

Dietary principle

A high calorie, adequate carbohydrate, adequate protein, low fat, low fibre, adequate vitamins and minerals, liberal fluid, bland and lactose free diet is prescribed for the patients.

Diet therapy for diarrhea

The therapy for diarrhoea consists of:

- Fluid and electrolyte management
- Dietary Management

1. Fluid and Electrolyte management

Early replacement of fluids and electrolytes through intravenous or oral route is necessary to reduce mortality associated with dehydration. Severe cases of diarrhoea need administration of dextrose and electrolyte solutions intravenously and hospitalization. Mild cases of diarrhoea can be treated at home by giving fluids like tender coconut water, buttermilk and rice kanji. This is referred to as the Oral Rehydration Therapy (ORT).

DO IT YOURSELF!

ORAL REHYDRATION THERAPY (ORT)

Oral Rehydration Therapy refers to providing oral salt solutions to the patients. An oral rehydration solution can be prepared by mixing 1 teaspoon of salt, 3 tablespoons of sugar with or without lemon juice in a litre of drinking water.

2. Dietary Management

Adequate nutritional care is important to ensure enhanced recovery and proper rehabilitation. The nutrient requirements and quality of diet may not be the same for all forms of diarrhoea. The demand for fluids and electrolytes are high during acute diarrhoea whereas the demand for macro and micro nutrients increases along with fluids and electrolytes during chronic diarrhoea.

Energy

During acute phase of diarrhoea, the intake of calories can be adjusted gradually as per patient's tolerance. A gradual increase of 200-300 kcal can be achieved easily. Easily digestible carbohydrates can be given for patients to improve calorie intake.

Protein

Protein requirements are increased in chronic diarrhoea because of tissue depletion. In chronic diarrhoea, an additional 10 g of protein is recommended above the normal requirement. In acute diarrhoea, adequate protein that is 1g per kg body weight is recommended. Protein rich foods that are easily digested like minced meat, egg, skimmed milk can be given for the

Oral Rehydration Solution (ORS)

Sodium Chloride	= 3.5g
Glucose	= 20g
Sodium bi carbonate	= 2.5g
Potassium chloride	= 1.5g

Dissolved in one litre of potable water

WHO STANDARD FORMULATION

ORS provides

Glucose	= 2g
Sodium	= 90 mEq/L
Potassium	= 20 mEq/L
Chloride	= 80 mEq/L
Bicarbonate	= 30 mEq/L
Osmolality	= 330 mOsm/L

UNIT-8_DIET IN GASTRO INTESTINAL AND LIVER DISORDERS.indd 125 25-02-2019 15:36:43